D H A R

Volume III — Ecosystem, Trust & Adoption

THE GUILD OF DHAR

“A guild trains the next smith. It doesn't gatekeep the forge.”

Document	The Guild of Dhar — Governance & Community
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Part of	The Canon of Dhar, Volume III
Depends on	Master Index §3.2 (status), §10 (amendment)
Audience	Contributors, community leads

1. Mandate

Give Dhar a governance model that matches where the project actually is, not where it wishes to be: a small, founder-led effort today, with a stated, credible path to broader stewardship as contributors arrive. This document does not invent a new amendment process for the Canon — the Master Index §10 already defines Draft → Proposed → Ratified. The Guild specifies who gets to move a document through those states, and how a contributor becomes one of the people who can.

2. Decision Rights Today

Every document in this Canon currently reaches Ratified status by the project lead's acceptance (Master Index §10). That is stated plainly rather than dressed up as something more distributed than it is: a governance document that pretends a one-person project already has a steering committee would be exactly the kind of overclaiming Tempering Dhar §1 and Casting Dhar §1 both explicitly rule out elsewhere in this Canon. The obligation this places on the project lead is to use §3's RFC process for any change a contributor proposes, rather than deciding informally outside a record anyone else can review.

3. The RFC Process

A Request for Comments is how a change to a Ratified document moves back to Proposed. It exists specifically for changes with a design decision in them — a new keyword, a changed default, a new Stage-delta module — not for typo fixes or clarifications, which may be corrected directly with a note in the affected document's own revision log.

1. Written proposal: what changes, in which document(s), and why — including what alternative was considered and rejected, following the same discipline Spec1's specification defaults already model.
2. Open comment period on the proposal, minimum two weeks, extended once if active discussion is ongoing when it would otherwise close.
3. Disposition: accepted, rejected, or returned for revision, with the reasoning recorded — a rejected RFC is kept, not deleted, so the same proposal isn't re-litigated from zero a year later.
4. An accepted RFC is implemented as a version bump to the affected document(s), with the RFC referenced by number in that document's revision log entry.

This is deliberately close to the process Rust and Python both use for language-level changes (Rust's RFC repository; Python's PEP process) — not copied for its own sake, but because both have run this exact process at scale for over a decade and the failure modes it avoids are well understood.

4. Contribution Guidelines

- Every commit carries a Developer Certificate of Origin sign-off (the same lightweight mechanism the Linux kernel uses) — a one-line attestation that the contributor has the right to submit the code under Dhar's license. For a project naming defence and critical-infrastructure adopters among its intended users (Spec0 §5), being able to show exactly who contributed what, and that they were entitled to, is not paperwork for its own sake.
- Code contributions to any Volume II stage follow that stage's own required architecture (one-definition-per-file, per Stage-alpha §3 and Stage-beta §3) — the Guild does not introduce a separate contribution standard when the engineering documents already ratified one.
- A first-time contributor's path in: a labeled backlog of scoped, real gaps (Casting Dhar §5 already commits to this), a review within a stated window, and a named point of contact — not a pull request into silence.

5. Code of Conduct

Participation is open regardless of nationality, background, or company affiliation, and is expected to stay technical: disagreement is with a proposal, not a person. Reports of conduct that falls short go to a named contact outside the immediate dispute, with a stated response window. This section stays short deliberately — a code of conduct that takes longer to read than the contribution guide gets read less, not more.

6. Toward a Foundation

A single-maintainer project is a real bus-factor risk (formalized in The Pact of Developing Dhar's risk register, Volume IV) that this document does not pretend otherwise. The realistic path, once Dhar has paid contributors, corporate users, or grant funding (Fueling Dhar) to steward: a small foundation modeled on the already-proven examples — the Rust Foundation (corporate-membership funded, formed 2021) or the Python Software Foundation (grants, sponsorship, and conference revenue) — rather than a bespoke structure invented from nothing. This Canon does not found that organization prematurely; it records the trigger condition (sustained outside funding or a multi-employer contributor base) so the transition is a planned decision, not a scramble.

7. Relationship to Other Volumes

This document assumes	Ratified in
The amendment process it wires the RFC into	Master Index §3.2, §10
The engineering standards contributions must follow	Stage-alpha §3, Stage-beta §3
The contributor pipeline referenced in §4	Casting Dhar §5
The bus-factor risk formalized in §6	The Pact of Developing Dhar (not yet written)

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